

1. Introduction

The "Introduction to Hack The Box" module provided a foundational overview of penetration testing and ethical hacking in a practical, hands-on environment. Designed for newcomers to cybersecurity, the module introduced key concepts such as reconnaissance, enumeration, exploitation, and privilege escalation. By working through interactive labs and simulated real-world machines, I learned how to think like an attacker while maintaining the mindset of a defender. The platform emphasized problem-solving, critical thinking, and persistence—core skills required for success in cybersecurity.

2. Module Sections

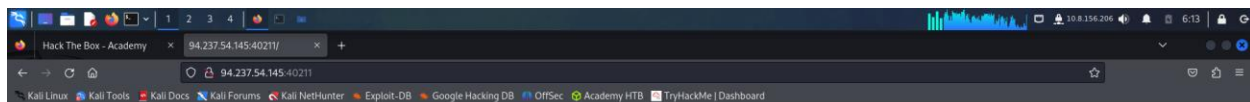
The image displays two screenshots of the Hack The Box Academy web interface. The top screenshot shows the completion page for a module, where the user has earned 2 cubes. The bottom screenshot shows a question page for a module, where the user has earned 3 cubes.

Top Screenshot: Module Completion

The browser address bar shows the URL: `https://academy.hackthebox.com/module/15/section/34`. The page title is "Intro to Academy". The page content includes a "Previous" button, a "Finish" button, and a "Success" message: "Congratulations! You earned 2 cubes!". Below this, there is a section for "Questions" with a "Cheat Sheet" button. The question is: "This module is a tier 0 'free' module. What is the total cubes that will be rewarded back to you by completing it?". The answer is "10". There are "Submit" and "Hint" buttons. At the bottom, there is a "Previous" button, a "Next" button, and a "Mark Complete & Next" button. A "Streak" section shows "10 Streak pts left to meet The Weekly Goal" and "20 / 30 Streak pts earned".

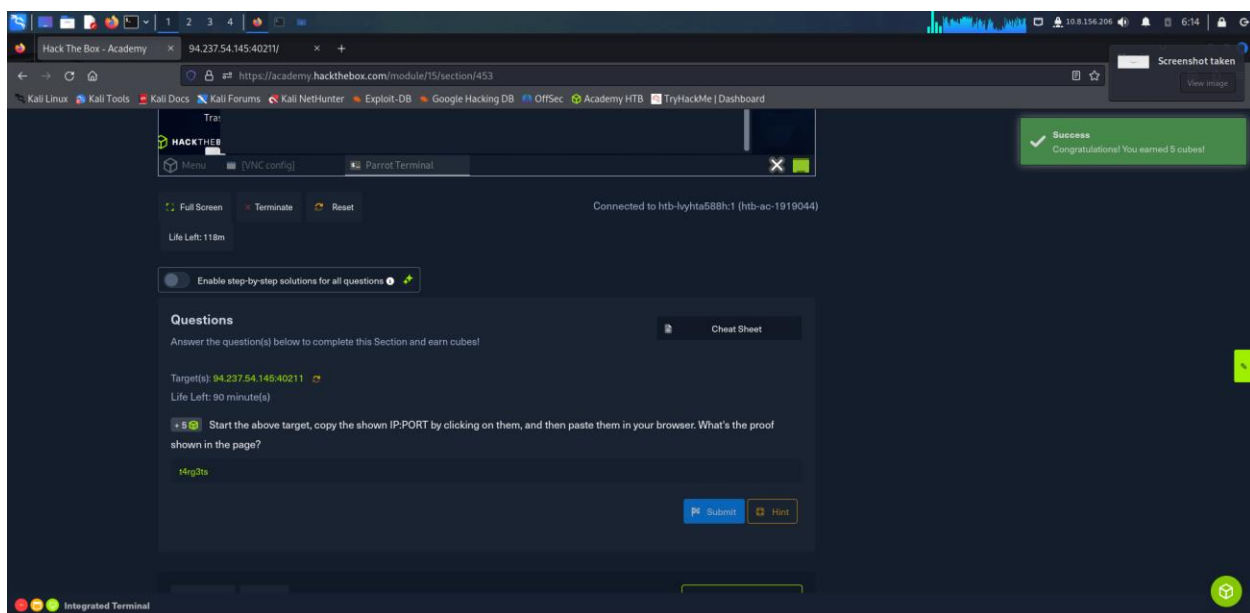
Bottom Screenshot: Module Question

The browser address bar shows the URL: `https://academy.hackthebox.com/module/15/section/35`. The page title is "Hack The Box - Academy". The page content includes a "README" section with a "HACKTHEBOX" logo. Below this, there is a "Questions" section with a "Cheat Sheet" button. The question is: "Start your workstation, then use the integrated terminal to find the Linux OS flavor by running the following command: `cat /etc/issue`". The answer is "Parrot Security 6.2 1n 1". There are "Submit" and "Hint" buttons. At the bottom, there is a "Full Screen" button, a "Terminate" button, and a "Reset" button. A "Streak" section shows "10 Streak pts left to meet The Weekly Goal" and "20 / 30 Streak pts earned".



Welcome to HTB Academy!

Proof: `14rg3ts`



5. Conclusion

Completing the Introduction to Hack The Box module has been both challenging and rewarding. It demystified the core techniques used in ethical hacking and gave me a strong foundation to build upon in more advanced modules. The hands-on nature of the training helped reinforce theoretical knowledge through direct application, boosting my confidence in using tools like Nmap, Gobuster, and basic Linux commands. Perhaps most importantly, it instilled a mindset of curiosity and continuous learning. I now feel better equipped to explore more complex penetration testing scenarios and am excited to deepen my skills in this dynamic field.